

SOP-UTIL-4800: Underground Utility Locating

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs the process for locating and marking underground utilities before any ground-disturbing work, standalone from and referenced by SOP-EXCAV-800.

Section 2. Locate Request Timing

Clause 2.1 — A locate request is submitted at least 3 working days before ground disturbance begins; an emergency locate (e.g., responding to an active leak) may be expedited but still requires request and response before mechanized digging.

Section 3. Locate Verification

Clause 3.1 — Facility-owned utility drawings are cross-referenced against field locate marks before work begins; a discrepancy between drawings and field marks is resolved by potholing (hand exposure) before mechanized excavation proceeds at that location.

Clause 3.2 — Locate marks degrade over time and with weather; marks older than 10 working days shall be re-verified before excavation resumes.

Section 4. Potholing

Clause 4.1 — Potholing (hand or vacuum excavation) to physically expose a marked utility is required before mechanized equipment operates within 24 inches of the mark, per SOP-EXCAV-800 Section 2.2.

Section 5. Utility Strike Response

Clause 5.1 — Any utility strike, even apparently minor, is reported immediately; work stops in the immediate area until the utility owner confirms the line's integrity and safety to resume, regardless of whether damage is visually apparent.

Section 6. Records

Clause 6.1 — Locate tickets and potholing records are filed to the Civil/Construction File and retained for 3 years.